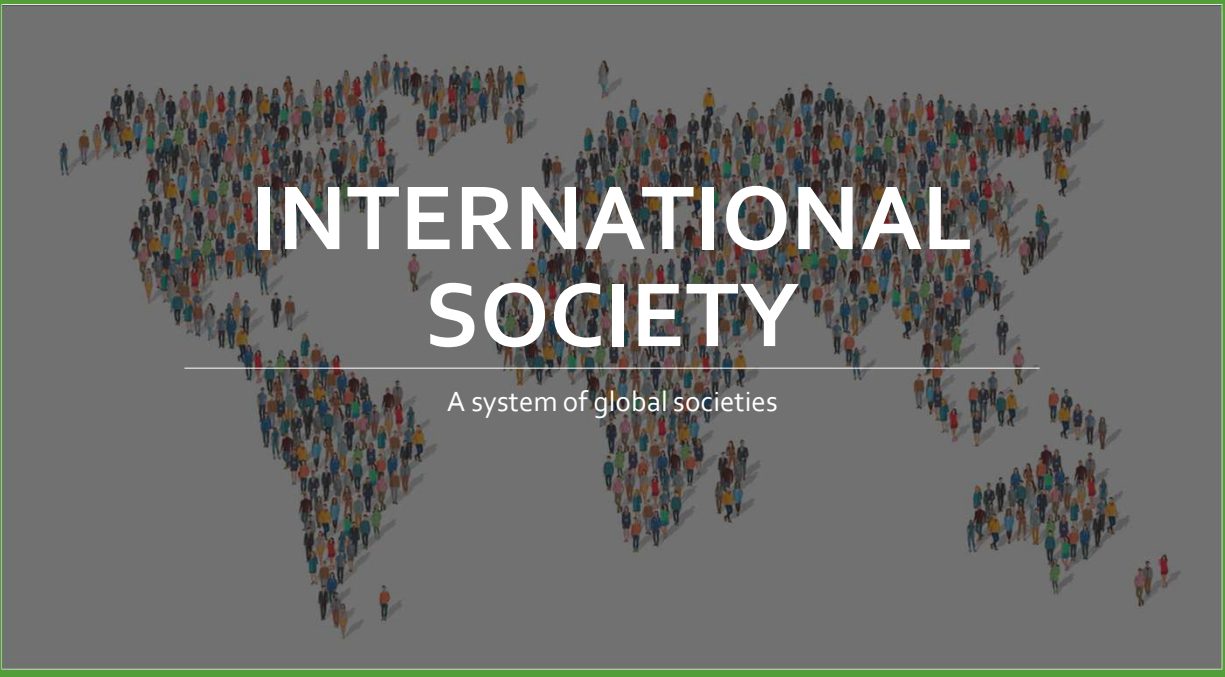




INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY

A system of global societies

The goals of each Monday session

Diving into a research framework/tradition of International Relations to:

1. Understand its **academic** and **global context**
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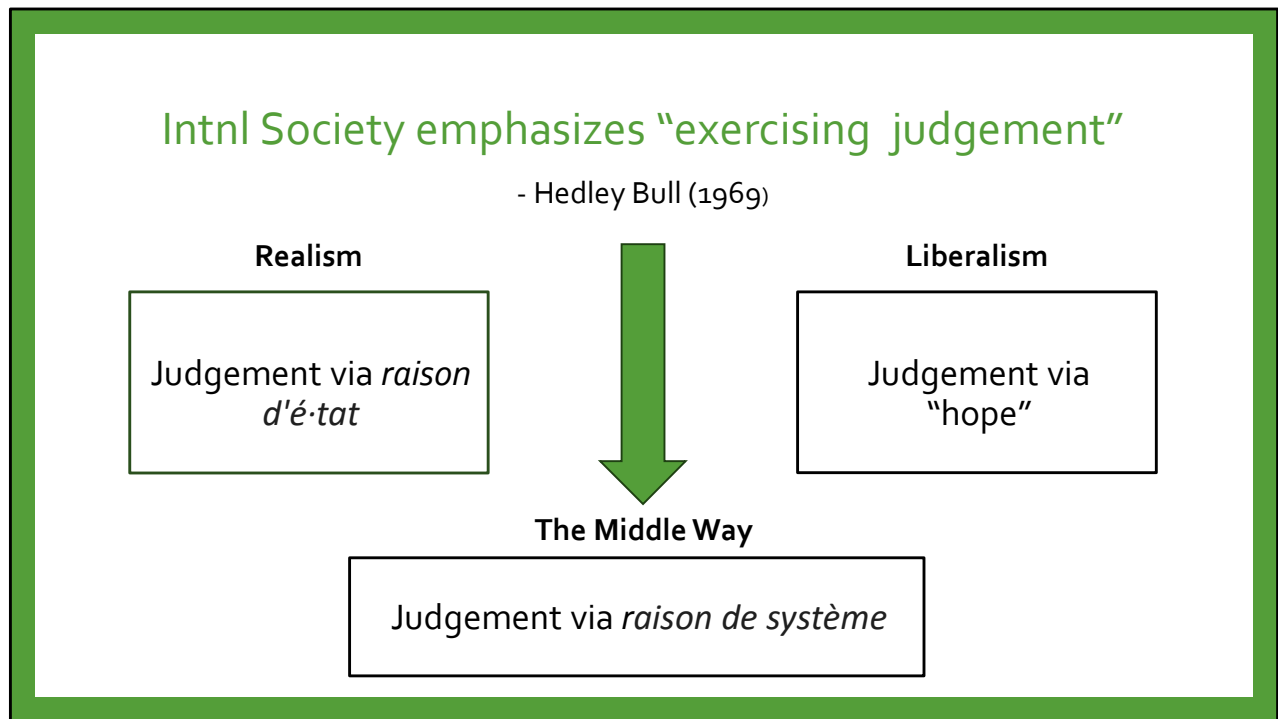
International Relations of the day (mostly)

Realism emphasizing

- Pessimistic
- Self-sufficient
- Instrumentalism
- Self-interest

Liberalism emphasizing

- Optimistic
- Institutional interaction
- Goodwill
- Cooperation



raison d'état (literal translation) – reason of the state, from *raison d'être* - reason for being

raison de système – indicating judgement that believes it pays to make the international system work for everyone (not only narrow self-interest)

"Hope" as distinct from "optimism" – optimism altering judgement based on expectations of positive outcome, hope as "a motivation to persevere towards a goal or end state, even if we're skeptical that a positive outcome is likely." –

<https://journalistsresource.org/home/hope-research-based-explainer/>

"Hope, optimism and delusion", McGuire-Snieckus (2014) –

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC4115405/>

Derived from **philosophy, history, law,**
and **practice...**

International Society emphasizes

- Outcomes through exercising judgement - Bull (1969)
- "*raison de système*" - Watson (1992)
- IR in a "formally anarchical, but substantively ordered social environment" - Linklater & Suganami (2006, p.47)

INVESTIGATING AN OXYMORON

Hedley Bull
(1995)
calls the
international
realm an
“anarchical
society”

Making sense of Bull's "anarchical society"

A system of states

When two or more states:

- have sufficient contact
- have sufficient impact on one another's decisions
- must consider the behavior of others in their own calculations

A society of states

When two or more states:

- are conscious of common values and interests
- perceive themselves bound by those shared common bonds
- form relationships and intuitions based upon those bonds

Under these concepts, Bull understands the international realm of his time to primarily consist of a system of states whose contact and decisions lacking a centralized overarching authority in which a society of states forms. Rather than reject anarchy they accept that the society of states highlighting rights like self-determination and obligations like non-intervention are indeed results of the anarchic system in which states interact.

The fundamental common bonds of international society are...

Order

"a pattern or disposition of international activity that sustains" the basic goals of the society of states

- Bull (1996, p.78)

Justice

The moral rules which "confer rights and duties upon states and nations"

- Bull (1996, p.78)

Bull suggests that order and justice are the two most primary common bonds of international society as we know it – we know this as the academic traditions of history, philosophy, and law all capture similar observations about the relationship among geo-political organizations group among themselves and relate according to their senses of order and justice.

Some additional values - Vincent (1986)

State Sovereignty

- Dominant common reasoning in the **19th Century**
- International society of sovereign states whose interactions are most often defined via **pluralist judgement**.

Human Rights

- Associated with the rising cosmopolitanism of **late modernity**
- growing human rights in the international society could indicate a "**world society**" where interactions are more often defined via **solidarist judgement**.

- Dunne (2010)

A slide to make sense of judgement

Pluralist emphasizes

- State sovereignty
- Co-existence among insecurity

Solidarist emphasizes

- Common purpose
- Individuals as the ultimate members of international society

Of note, what is plural here are the domestic civil values within each state. What makes it a plural judgement is the acceptance of other forms of government based on distinct domestic civil values by upholding state sovereignty as the ordering value of the system. This way, all states are given equal parity through sovereignty, even when the domestic values vary widely (plural).

A few examples to speak of...

in light of global violent conflict:

- League of Nations (1920-1945) -> to end WWI
- Kellogg-Braind Pact (1928)
- United Nations Charter (1945)
- Intl Military Tribunals (IMT) -> Nuremburg and Tokyo Trials (1939-1948)*
- Council of Europe (1949)

*asterisk indicates UN facilitated/authorized

League of Nations funding source - <https://www.martingrandjean.ch/funding-league-of-nations/>

A few examples to speak of...

in light of post-war development:

- UN's Refugee (Geneva) Convention (1951)*
- European Convention on Human Rights (1953)
- International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (1965)*
- Rome Statute creating the Intl Criminal Court (ICC)
 - -> Regional conflict tribunals in Rwanda, Yugoslavia, Sierra Leone, Cambodia (1992-2022)
- UN's Child Rights Convention (1989)*
- UN's Responsibility to Protect (2005)*
- European Union Fundamental Rights Agency (2007)
- Paris Agreement (2016)

*asterisks indicate UN facilitated/authorized

International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination
article - <https://www.universal-rights.org/how-the-global-south-shaped-the-international-human-rights-system/>

What do
you think?

Does this behavior sound to you like
a move from **pluralist** judgement to
solidarist judgement?

Does this **historical** evidence of state
philosophy set to **legal** terms
indicate an international society or a
world/cosmopolitan society?

Let's consider a common alternative IR perspective of the time...

Neo-Marxism

- Focused on state economic structures as a primary ordering principle in IR
- Highlighted a capitalist world system through which state calculations are made
- Emphasized the dependency and underdevelopment commonly resulting from this system
- Noted a disparity between states at the “core” and those at the “periphery”
- Core society often identified as Global North or The West
- Often critical of Euro-centrism predominant in IR research

During these lessons covering new approaches, I encourage you all to try your best to make comparisons with approaches we previously covered. Returning to previous lessons can help to place the new information in context, and acts as a review of older information so you build a stronger individual relationship with information you “already know”.

Post-war example slide again

- UN's Refugee (Geneva) Convention (1951)*
- European Convention on Human Rights (1953)
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A more collaborative story - Waltz (2002)

"According to Waltz (2002), the institutionalization of human rights came out as a result of active collaboration between both Western and Non-Western countries, making it both **pluralist** and **global**.

The UN General Assembly in 1946 bore witness to the statement as non-Western countries such as Egypt, India, Cuba, and Haiti argued for resolution against issues such as racism, genocide, and apartheid system in South Africa (Lauren 2011).

On contrary, Western countries such as Australia, United Kingdom, and the USA supported South Africa claiming state sovereignty and non-intervention rule after being criticized of its apartheid system (Lauren 2011)."

- Ahdanisa & Rothman (2021)

Ahdanisa, D. S., & Rothman, S. B. (2021). Revisiting international human rights treaties: comparing Asian and Western efforts to improve human rights. *SN social sciences*, 1(1), 16. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43545-020-00018-0>

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TABLE 5.2 Wight's three IR traditions

REALISM	RATIONALISM	REVOLUTIONISM
Anarchy	Society	Humanity
Power politics	Evolutionary change	Revolutionary change
Conflict and warfare	Peaceful coexistence	Global community
Pessimism	Hope without illusions	Utopianism

Based on [Wight \(1991: 47\)](#)

The Middle Way

Judgement via *raison de système*

Image from Ch 5 Textbook

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I don't know each of your individual interests, preferences, or life goals, so this one is up to you all. You don't need to have all 3 “so-whats” figured out today, but I challenge you to not leave from class until you are confident you can identify and communicate at least 1 of these “so-whats” – otherwise, why give up 1.25 precious hours of your life. IR has been around for only 100 years, the USA for 250, European international society for ~300, while the average global human lifespan is ~70 years – make the most of it!

Looking towards the lab

- Wednesday's Lab has us utilizing International Society approaches to better understand or predict IR outcomes and relationships during an alien encounter.
- Focus on the primary data considered: **history, philosophy, law, statesmanship**
- Utilize the concepts: **international system, international society, world/cosmopolitan society, pluralism, and solidarism**
- Consider the **implications** of categorizing the world via the above concepts on our **expectations** of the global response to an alien encounter.
- Remember that these abstractions are useful for making the most of IR research (an alien encounter scenario shares some features with the addition of a new sovereign state to the international system of states)